

No Ejection Now—

Teeth Taken Out of New Spitball Rule

United Press International

FORT LAUDERDALE, Fla., March 12.—Baseball's controversial spitball rule, a distasteful piece of legislation to members of the pitching fraternity, was amended today to lessen the penalty to the offending pitcher.

Baseball's top echelon agreed to the change which will be submitted to the playing rules committee for consideration at its meeting later this spring.

THE NEW RULE adopted during the winter meetings at Mexico City called for ejection of pitchers using the illegal pitch. The amendment repeals the ejection clause of the rule and charges the offending pitcher with an illegal pitch.

Previously a pitcher was ejected from the game after an original warning from the umpire. The unusually large number of ejections in spring training rules prompted baseball brass to make the change.

The amendment, in effect, makes the illegal pitch a balk, when runners are on base, or a ball when the bases are empty.

COMMISSIONER William Eckert, National League president Warren Giles and American League president Joe Cronin agreed to the change in the interest of uniformity.

Following a warning from the umpire the infraction will become an illegal pitch.

A spokesman for the major leagues said several pitchers who through force of habit bring their pitching hand to their mouth had been thrown out of games this spring.

Another rule covering repeated illegal pitches could result in banishment from the game.